

A SHORT STORY ABOUT INTERNAL SOFTWARE

The spreadsheet that runs the company.

Every company we talk to has one. This is what happens to it — and why replacing it is harder than it should be.



ONE

Somewhere in the building, there is a file called **Planning_v7_FINAL.xlsx**

It handles the approvals. Or the quotes. Or the shift roster, or which lorry goes where. It has forty-one tabs, six of which nobody opens any more.

It was built by someone in operations, years ago, on a Tuesday. It works. It has always worked.

Planning_v7_FINAL.xlsx						41 tabs
	DEPOT	DRIVER	LOAD	APPROVED BY	STATUS	NOTES
1	Rotterdam	J. Bakker	14t	M.V. ✓	Confirmed	—
2	Antwerp	P. Claes	9t	M.V. ✓	Confirmed	—
3	Rotterdam	—	22t	??	Pending	ask Marta
4	Eindhoven	S. de Vries	11t	M.V. ✓	Confirmed	—
5	Antwerp	—	—	—		moved from Tue
6	Rotterdam	K. Jansen	17t	?	Pending	who signed?
7	Ghent	—	8t	M.V. ✓	Confirmed	—
8	Eindhoven	T. Mol	13t	??	Pending	—
Last edited 3 days ago by someone who has since left.						

TWO

It works right up until the week it doesn't.

Growth

A second depot opens. The file now needs to be in two places at once, and it cannot be.

Error

Someone sorts one column without the others. Three weeks later a customer finds out before you do.

Audit

A client asks who approved what, and when. The answer is in an email thread nobody can find.

Departure

The person who built it takes another job. Nobody else understands the formulas.

None of these are software problems yet. They are the moment a company discovers that a process it depends on **was never actually designed.**

So they go looking for software. There are three doors, and each one sticks.

DOOR ONE

Build it in-house

Which requires developers. Hiring one in Western Europe takes four to six months and a salary the company was not planning for — and one developer alone cannot maintain a system either.

Sticks because: the cost and the wait are both larger than the problem felt.

DOOR TWO

Buy something standard

Which is the right answer surprisingly often — until you reach the part of the process that is specific to how this company actually competes. Then it is 70% fit and a permanent workaround.

Sticks because: the missing 30% is usually the part that mattered.

DOOR THREE

Hire someone to build it

The obvious answer. A small supplier, a fixed scope, six weeks. And this is where most of these stories quietly stop — not over price, and not over technology.

Sticks because: of the four questions on the next slide.

FOUR

The deal does not stall on price. It stalls in legal.

A supplier is found. The quote is fine. The demo is good. Then someone in finance or legal asks four ordinary questions — and the answers take three weeks to assemble, or never arrive at all.

Nobody is being difficult. These are simply the questions a European company has to ask before data leaves the building.

ASKED BY EVERY BUYER, EVENTUALLY

- 01 Which legal entity are we contracting with, and where?
- 02 How does the invoice work for our accounts team?
- 03 Where will our data sit, and who can reach it?
- 04 When are you actually available in our working day?

FIVE

What if the supplier had already answered all four — before anyone thought to ask?

01 · ENTITY

An EU company you can look up

Registered in Estonia. A registry number anyone can verify in a public register in under a minute.

02 · INVOICE

The invoice they already know

A standard intra-EU reverse-charge invoice. Finance has processed a thousand of them.

03 · DATA

EU hosting, written down honestly

EU region by default, a DPA under EU law, and a straight answer about who can access what, from where.

04 · HOURS

Live in their afternoon

14:00–18:00 CET, every working day. Not “flexible”. A window you can book.



A small Estonian software company that builds the boring thing properly.

We replace the spreadsheets, email chains and disconnected tools that European operations teams run on. Internal systems — approvals, records, quoting, scheduling, reporting — built around how a business actually works.

We are deliberately small, and we say so. That makes us the wrong choice for anyone who needs a large team, and a reasonable one for a company that wants a narrow system built well by people who answer their own email.

THE FOUR ANSWERS, IN ADVANCE

Contracting entity	Nexarrow OÜ, Estonia
Registry	17521430
VAT	EE102992676
Invoicing	Intra-EU reverse charge
Hosting	EU region by default
Engineering team	India
Live availability	14:00–18:00 CET

We publish the last two rather than being asked for them. A supplier who is vague about where their engineers sit is telling you something.

Four things, and the one we would rather talk about.

WHERE WE START

Internal operations software

Approvals, records, scheduling, quoting, field data, reporting. The unglamorous systems that decide how fast a company can actually move.

This is the work we are best at and the work most suppliers find too boring to want.

ALSO

SaaS product foundations

Multi-tenant architecture, dashboards, user and billing systems — the structural work that decides whether a product stays maintainable at version four.

ALSO

AI workflows with EU data residency

Retrieval, document handling and assistants wired into real approval paths — hosted in the EU, with written evidence of how they behave.

ALSO

Cloud deployment and reliability

CI/CD, environments, monitoring and the release discipline that keeps a growing product operable rather than fragile.

We would rather build one workflow completely than four of them to eighty per cent.

A narrow system that people use every day beats a broad one that gets abandoned. It is also the only honest thing a small team can promise — and it is why our first engagement is almost always smaller than the client expected.

Six weeks, and you can open it in week two.

WEEK 01

Understand

Interviews with the people who do the work. Scope agreed in writing.

WEEK 02

You can click it

A working version on a URL. Ugly, incomplete, real.

WEEK 03

The hard part

The genuinely difficult logic. Expect awkward questions this week.

WEEK 04

Roles and edges

Permissions, error states, the cases nobody mentioned in week one.

WEEK 05

Real data

Migration and testing with your actual records, not samples.

WEEK 06

Handover

Deployment, documentation, training. The old process gets a retirement date.

WHAT YOU GET

- Fixed scope, milestone-billed
- The code and accounts in your name from day one
- A written architecture note
- Documented handover as a deliverable, not a favour

WHAT WE NEED

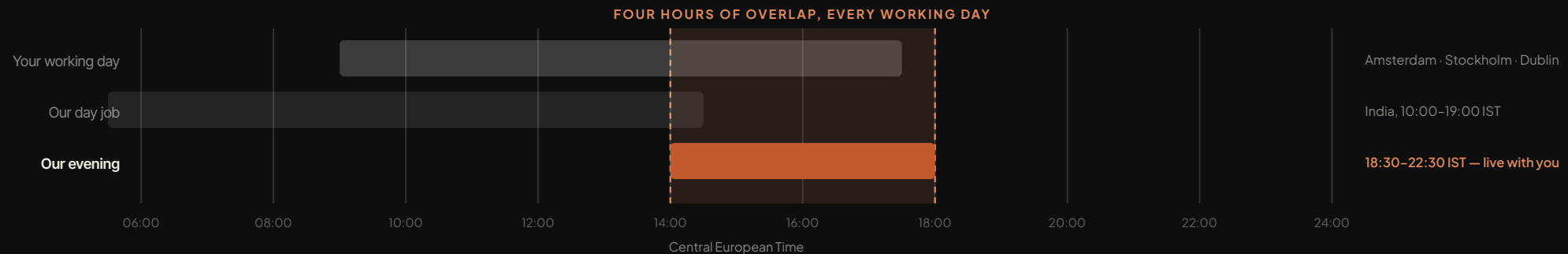
- One person who can decide
- Two to four hours of your team's time each week
- Real data, not sanitised samples
- Answers inside 48 hours

WHAT WE WILL TELL YOU

- When a request is about to become expensive
- When something went wrong that week
- When you should buy software instead of building it
- When we are the wrong firm for the job

The part people assume we cannot do.

Most European buyers assume a team in India means messages answered overnight and calls at awkward hours. For us the opposite is true — and it is the single most useful accident of geography in this business.



Your afternoon is our evening. We are live 14:00–18:00 CET, every working day.

That is four hours of genuine overlap for calls, demos, live debugging and decisions — inside your working day, every day, not once a week at an inconvenient hour. It is written into our contracts and it is the only availability claim we make.

It starts small, on purpose.

STEP ONE

Operations Diagnostic

€1,900

Five working days, mostly asynchronous

- Two interviews in your afternoon
- A written map of the process
- What is worth automating, ranked
- A costed recommendation

You keep the report either way. The fee is credited in full against any build started within sixty days.

STEP TWO

One workflow, built

€9,500–18,000

Five to eight weeks, fixed scope

- One process, end to end
- Roles, permissions, audit trail
- Two integrations
- EU deployment and handover

STEP THREE

Keep it alive

€3,900+ /mo

Rolling, three-month minimum

- A fixed monthly hour bank
- A named engineer
- EU-afternoon availability
- A written monthly report

OR NOT AT ALL

The diagnostic is genuinely standalone

Roughly a third of the value in a project like this is deciding correctly what to build. If the report concludes you should buy something off the shelf, fix a process, or do nothing this year, that is a real outcome and we will say so.

We would rather be the firm that told you not to spend €15,000 than the one that took it.

Where we honestly are right now.

Nexarrow is early. We would rather say that on a slide than have you discover it in a reference call.

What that means in practice: you would be an early client, and you should price that in. It also means you get the two founders on your project rather than whoever was available, and a level of attention that stops being possible at scale.

WHAT WE CAN SHOW YOU

- Working systems you can open and click through
- The architecture decisions behind them, written down
- How we run our own operations — the same way we would run yours
- A fixed scope and a date, before you commit

WHAT WE CANNOT SHOW YOU YET

- A long client list
- A ten-year track record
- A team of thirty
- Anyone else to blame if it goes wrong

SELECTED WORK

[Case study 1 — replace with a real project]

[Case study 2]

[Case study 3]

Add each as: the problem in a number, what you built, how long it took, and the same number afterwards. One line each on this slide; the detail lives on the website.

THE EARLY-CLIENT TRADE

For our first engagements we offer a reduced rate in exchange for a named reference and permission to write the project up. If that suits you, say so — it is a fair exchange and we would rather make it explicit than pretend the discount is a promotion.

AND SO

Send us the spreadsheet.

Genuinely. Show us the file, or the process, or the thing that keeps needing a person to hold it together. Two conversations in your afternoon and we will tell you what it would take to fix — and whether it is worth fixing at all.

If the answer is no, that is a useful afternoon for both of us.

FIVE WORKING DAYS

€1,900, CREDITED AGAINST A BUILD

YOU KEEP THE REPORT

 NexarrowEmail **hello@nexarrow.eu**Web **nexarrow.eu**Company **Nexarrow OÜ**Registry · VAT **17521430 · EE102992676**Based **Tallinn, Estonia**Live hours **14:00–18:00 CET**

Ask us the four questions from slide five. We will answer all of them in one email, before you have to chase.